AA-D-191a
Interim Amendment-3
December 22, 1960

INTERIM AMENDMENT TO

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DESKS, STEEL, GENERAL OFFICE

(This interim Amendment to Federal Specification AA-D-191a was prepared by Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C., based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim Amendment as a valid exception to Federal Specification AA-D-191a DESKS, STEEL, GENERAL OFFICE.

Page 1, paragraph 1.2.2 delete, "Gray, Olive Green" and substitute:

"Gray of Federal Standard 595, color chip No. 26134 for all surfaces".

Page 1, paragraph 1.2.2, parenthetical paragraph, delete and substitute:

"(Color chip No. 26134 Gray, of Federal Standard 595 is obtainable from Business Service Center, General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington 25, D. C. or from Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.)"

Page 1, paragraph 2.1, Federal Specifications. Add the following:

L-P-00508 (GSA-FSS) - Plastic Sheet, Laminated, Decorative and Nondecorative.

Page 1, after Federal Specifications, add: Federal Standards

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preserving, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Use).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

Page 2, Figure 1, Type II, Class 1 desk; second line: Change "Style A" to "Style B"; third line, change "Style B similar" to "Style A similar".

Pages 2 and 3, Figures 1 and 2: Change minimum height of center drawer from 2 inches to 1-1/2 inches.

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Page 4. Add the following paragraph:

"3.1.2.1 Plastic sheet.- When plastic tops are specified in the invitation for bids, the plastic sheet shall conform to the requirements of Interim Federal Specification L-P-00508 (GSA-FSS), Style D, Type I, Grade HP, Class 1, Finish A. The plastic sheet shall be 0.062 inches thick with a plus or minus tolerance of 0.005 inch. The plastic color shall match the standard plastic color adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration. "

Page 5, paragraph 3.1.3.4, at end of paragraph, add (See figure 3).

Page 5, paragraph 3.1.3.5. Delete "Linoleum binding strip". Insert "Binding strip".

1st sentence. Delete "linoleum".

2nd sentence, after "linoleum" add "or plastic sheet".

Following 2nd sentence add, "The inserting webb of the binding strip shall be serrated or embossed to grip the channel where it is inserted".

Last sentence, after "linoleum" add "or plastic sheet".

Page 5, paragraph 3.1.3.5, change "period" at end of paragraph to "comma and add: "Nor shall the top material project more than 1/4 of its thickness above the binding strip. The binding strip shall be either vertically flush with outside of the edgemold or may extend outside the edgemold by not more than 1/16 inch.

Page 5, paragraph 3.1.4, line 18, after the word "typewriter", add "The top of the platform in raised position shall be 26½ inches above the floor".

Page 5, paragraph 3.1.5.2, 6th line, change 300° to 250°.

Page 5, paragraph 3.2.1.1, 5th line after "contracting officer" add: "or his authorized representative".

7th and 8th line, delete "control guide" and substitute: "representative".

Page 5. paragraph 3.2.2: At end of paragraph, change period to semicolon and add: "height of typewriter platform plus or minus 1/2 inch."

Page 6, paragraph 3.2.3, 9th line after "members" add: "Bolt holes diameter shall not excede the diameter of the bolt or screw to be used therein by more than 1/16 inch or the hole may be elliptical with the dimensions of the minor axes not exceeding 1/32 inch and the major axes not exceeding 3/16 inch over the diameter of the bolt or screw to be used therein".

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Page 6, paragraph 3.2.3, 13th line after "desk", add new sentence:

"Spot welds shall not come closer to the edge of adjoining members than 1/2 the diameter of the spot weld, and not closer together than 2 spot weld diameters." And at end of paragraph add:

"In the assembly of double pedestal desks to the top where each sides of each pedestal is not secured by bolts, nuts and lockwashers or metal screws and extruded holes, the pedestal sides shall be reinforced by a front and rear 16 gage formed member (other than embossed) attached by no less than one bolt, nut and lockwasher or welded at each top flange of the four side sections, joining the two pedestals rigidly in line."

Page 6, paragraph 3.2.4. After the second sentence, add the following:

"When specified in the invitation for bids, the top plate shall be covered with plastic sheet as specified in 3.1.2.1 in lieu of linoleum. The plastic sheet shall be bonded uniformly to the top plate by an adhesive recommended by the adhesive manufacturer for use with metal and shall be applied at a temperature recommended by the adhesive manufacturer to insure even adhesion. The steel top plate shall be properly cleaned prior to application of the adhesive. Adhesive shall be applied to both top plate and plastic sheet and dried to remove solvents. After the plastic has been applied to the steel top plate, pressure shall be applied within the range of 5 pounds per square inch minimum and 50 pounds per square inch maximum by a method which will not cause uneven adhesion over the reinforcing members of the top plate."

3rd sentence. Delete "linoleum".

4th sentence. Delete "linoleum".

Page 6, paragraph 3.2.4. 17th line after "linoleum" add "a press fit of the binding strip will not be considered secure."

Also, same paragraph, delete next to last sentence and substitute:

"For all desks except the Type II, Class 2 desk, the binder strip shall be of not more than two pieces each and shall be butt joined on either end or both ends of the desk; for the Type II, Class 2 desk, the binder strip may be of more than two pieces."

Page 6. paragraph 3.2.5. after first sentence add:

"The drawer fronts shall fit square in the drawer opening and shall show equal opening between the drawer front and pedestal frame, on the sides and top when the drawers are closed."

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Page 6, paragraph 3.2.5. Second column, 10th line, after "drawer bottom", add "Alternatively, end flanges on inner drawer head and bottom extrusions may be omitted when the inner drawer head is secured by the drawer pull and the attaching point is a recessed channel running the full length of the inner drawer head." 14th line after "steel" add "Alternatively the back shall be flanged for spot welding to the drawer body." 17th line, after "drawer sides", add: "and backs", then delete the sentence beginning on line 30. Line 43, delete comma after compartment and add for type I desks, and not less than two 3 inch compartments and one pencil compartment on type II desks, and not less than two 3 inch compartments and one pencil compartment on type II desks.
44th line, change "1 inch" to "3/4 inch."

Page 7, paragraph 3.2.5, 13th line, add "body" after "drawer".

Page 7, paragraph 3.2.3.1, delete in its entirety and substitute:

"3.2.5.1 Drawer suspensions and stops.- The drawer suspension shall be constructed without rough or sharp edges and to insure durability and ease of operation when the drawer has a minimum load of 40 pounds evenly distributed in the letter file drawer, 20 pounds in each of the storage drawers. The drawer fronts shall not touch when drawers are equally extended or during the full course of travel when adjoining drawers are opened or closed at the same time. The double height letter filing drawer shall be located in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial standards and shall operate on a zinc or cadmium plated or black oxide finished progressive suspension slide or a ball-bearing roller channel suspension. Each drawer shall be equipped with stops which shall prevent the drawer from falling out when fully extended but will permit easy removal of the drawer when desired. The pull to fully open pedestal drawers when loaded shall not be more than 3-3/4 pounds. The pedestal drawers shall contact rubber bumpers on the inward movement to reduce noise to a minimum when in use. Letter file drawers shall have rubber bumpers on either the inward or the outward stop or bumpers may be on both the inward and outward stop. The front of the pedestal drawers shall be flush with the front section of the desk or may be inset not more than 1/16 inch, when in a closed position."

Page 7, paragraph 3.2.5.2. 7th line from bottom of paragraph after "paper" add new sentence: "The top edge of sloping trays including cutout portion shall be folded or beaded to protect fingers and the bottom edge shall be flanged up fitting tightly against the tray above to prevent papers from slipping between the trays or between the tray and the drawer bottom."

Page 7, paragraph 3.2.6, 25th line, after "pedestal side", add "or skeleton side section." 28th line, change period after "section" to a comma and add "or the front edge of the bottom may be spot welded to the bottom channel of the front section."

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Page 8, paragraph 3.2.6, 7th line, after "Each pedestal side" add "or side section."

Page 8, paragraph 3.2.6, line 11, At end of sentence add: The Z shaped braces shall be approximately the full height of the pedestal and equally spaced between the front and back of the pedestal not closer to the front or back of the pedestal than 4 inches and spot welded to panels of 22 gage steel on not more than 6 inches center to center.

Page 8, paragraph, 3.2.7, at end of paragraph add: "Desk legs shall be square with the pedestal when secured thereto."

Page 8, paragraph 3.2.11, 9th line: Change "1 inch" to "3/4 inch."

Page 8, paragraph 3.2.12, 9th line: Delete "back and front", 10th line, after "over" delete "and" then add "forming a double thickness across the front, the side shall be.", 18th line, after "coil" add "or leaf", 19th line, after "desk" add "Alternatively, the shelf may operate on 18 gauge (0.0478) steel runners when the steel runners formed channel and Z-shape shall be incorporated as part of a one-piece formed assembly consisting of the desk front and rear horizontal tie members, the two steel runners, and the necessary reinforcing gussets and stops."

Page 9, paragraph 3.3, delete and substitute:

3.3 Finish.- All exterior and interior steel surfaces of the desk except hardware, shall be prepared for painting in accordance with 3.1.5.1. All surfaces of the desk and drawers shall be enameled. The enamel shall conform to the requirements of 3.1.5.2. The average finished film thickness on exposed enameled surfaces shall be 1.4 mils. with no reading less than 1.1 mils. Alternatively when the metal is prepared for enameling by grade I or grade III of Military Specification MIL-C-490a the dry enamel thickness may average 1.0 mil and no reading less than 0.7 mils. The enamel shall be baked for not less than 45 minutes at 250° degrees or equivalent time-temperature cycle as recommended by the enamel manufacturer. The finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform exposed surfaces without runs, wrinkles, grit, areas of thin film or no film, and separation of color . Special attention shall be given to the bottoms and to the interior to insure that all surfaces are adequately protected against rust. Finish panels shall withstand the test specified in 4.3.4.

Pages 9 and 10, delete 4, 4.1, 4.1.1 and 4.2 and substitute:

"4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.1.1 Inspection lot.- Normally, the inspection lot size shall consist of all units submitted for inspection at one time.

4.1.2 Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection.- Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

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4.2 Inspection.- The desks shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification as to workmanship, materials, design, details of construction, hardware, finish, tests, marking and packing. Inspection shall be made at any time during process of manufacture, or at point of delivery.

4.2.1 Contractor inspection.- Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2.2 Contractor quality assurance system.- The contractor shall provide and maintain an effective quality assurance system acceptable to the Government covering the supplies under this specification. Results of all examinations and tests performed under the quality assurance system shall be made available to the Government. A current written description of the system shall be submitted to the Government prior to initiation of production. The written description will be considered acceptable when, as a minimum, it provides the quality assurance required by this specification and other documents referenced herein. The contractor will not be restricted to the inspection station or to the method of inspection listed provided that an equivalent control is included in the approved quality assurance procedure. In cases of dispute as to whether certain procedures of the system provide equal assurance, the comparable procedure of the detail specification will be used. The contractor shall notify the Government of and obtain approval for any change to the written procedure that affects the degree of assurance required by this specification or other documents referenced herein.

4.2.3 Government verification.- All quality assurance operations performed by the contractor shall be subjected to Government verification at unscheduled intervals. Verification will consist of surveillance of the operations to determine whether the practices, methods, and procedures of the written inspection plan are being properly applied, and the Government product inspection to measure quality of product offered for acceptance. Deviation from the prescribed or agreed-upon procedures; or instances of poor practices which might have an affect upon the quality of the product will be immediately called to the attention of the contractor. Failure of the contractor to promptly correct deficiencies discovered shall be cause for suspension of acceptance until correction has been made or until conformance of product to prescribed criteria has been demonstrated. To avoid interference with operations, the contractor shall designate a responsible official or officials to whom the Government inspector will report such instances."

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Page 9, 10 and 11, delete all of section 5 and substitute:

"5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing for civilian procurements).

5.1 Preservation and packaging.- Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.- Packaging shall be as specified in the invitation for bids.

5.1.2 Level C.- Desks shall be packaged according to manufacturers regular commercial practice to assure safe delivery of goods at destination.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, C, or D as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.- Packing shall be as specified in the invitation for bids.

5.2.2 Level B.- Packing shall be as specified in the invitation for bids.

5.2.3 Level C.- Desks preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or regulations or other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.4 Level D.- Desks preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at overseas destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the modes of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civilian agencies.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123 and as specified in 5.3.3.

5.3.2 Military requirements.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129 and as specified in 5.3.3.

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5.3.3 Additional marking.- In addition to the marking specified herein, arrows or prominent marks shall be placed on the sides of each shipping container to indicate the position in which the container shall be handled during shipment. The word "UP" shall be placed at the point of the arrows in letters at least 2 inches in height.

The front panel of each shipping container shall be plainly marked as follows:

UP FURNITURE UP

FRAGILE, HANDLE
WITH CARE

Top panels shall be plainly marked as follows:

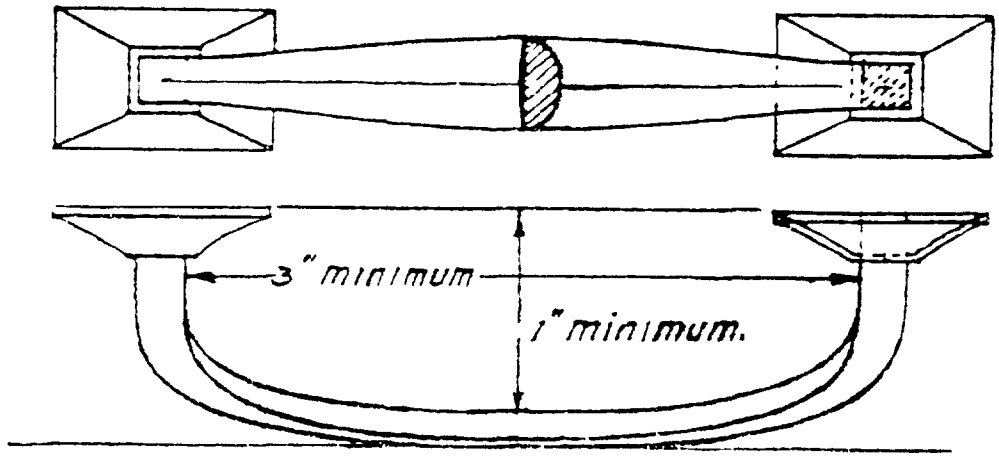
FURNITURE
FRAGILE, HANDLE WITH CARE
TOP
THIS SIDE UP

Page 12, paragraph 6.1, delete and substitute:

6.1 Definitions (see section 5).- Federal Standard No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.

6.1.1 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) If plastic top is required (see 3.2.4).
(b) Other than contractors inspection (see 4.2.1)
(c) If marking according to MIL-STD-130 is required (see 3.4)
(d) If level A, B, C, or D packaging and packing is required (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(e) If Civilian or Military marking is required (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2)



Drawer Pull

FIGURE 3

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